

The Compliance Calendar & Task Assignment Workflow

How it works today, and how to make it better

A plain-language walkthrough of how a filing deadline is created, how it shows up on the compliance calendar, how it gets assigned to a person, and how it's tracked to completion — written for anyone reading it, technical or not — followed by a prioritised list of ways to make the workflow more reliable and easier to work with.

22 September 2026

1. Executive summary

The compliance calendar is not a to-do list someone types up by hand. It is generated automatically: a library of filing rules is compared every night against what is known about each client, and the system creates, updates or retires filing deadlines on its own. The calendar simply shows this list by date, and “task assignment” is the act of attaching a person's name to a row on that list so the work actually gets done.

That automation is a real strength: nobody manually re-keys deadlines, and nothing a person has already acted on gets silently overwritten overnight. But the way work is handed off, checked, and reassigned between people has not kept pace with that strength.

The single biggest finding

Internal expectations describe a strict separation between the person who **prepares** a filing and the person who **reviews or approves** it — a control a firm would want to be able to point to for a client or an auditor. As things stand today, that separation is not actually enforced: the same person can prepare and approve their own filing, and the review hand-off is currently hidden from view for day-to-day tracking. This needs a deliberate decision, not a quiet mismatch between what is promised and what is shipped.

Beyond that headline item, this review surfaces a handful of smaller but concrete gaps: work can be auto-assigned to someone who does not actually have access to that client, there is no quick way to move many small tasks off someone who has left the team, nobody can see where work is genuinely getting slow (only what is currently overdue), and a checklist can look “complete” after only one of several required documents has been uploaded. Each is addressed with a concrete recommendation in the closing section.

2. How a deadline lands on the calendar

Three layers sit behind every date a user sees, each protected by its own rule:

- **Jurisdiction facts.** Country- and calendar-specific reference data — the financial-year convention, public holidays, the categories a business or filing can belong to. This is shared background knowledge, not something tied to any one client.
- **The rulebook.** For every kind of filing (a GST return, a TDS payment, an income-tax form), there is a versioned rule describing who it applies to and how its due date is calculated. Once a rule has been published, it is never edited in place — correcting it always means publishing a new, dated version. This means the system can always answer “what did the rule say on this date” months or years later, which matters when a filing from a past period is questioned.
- **The nightly update.** Every night, an automatic process compares each client's known facts against the current rulebook and brings that client's task list up to date — adding filings that newly apply, retiring ones that no longer do, and recalculating due dates as facts change. This process is careful in two ways that matter for trust: it never re-creates a filing a person has deliberately dismissed as not applicable, and it never deletes a filing a person has deliberately added by hand. A person's judgement always overrides the automatic sweep, not the other way around.

A filing's due date is always a calendar date (“20 September”), never a date-and-time. That sounds like a small detail, but it matters: a legal deadline is a day, and storing anything more precise invites

exactly the kind of off-by-one-day confusion that shows up around midnight or across time zones. When a government extends a deadline, the extension is applied as an adjustment on top of the original date — the original statutory date is always still visible, shown struck through, rather than being overwritten and lost.

3. The calendar, as a user sees it

There are three ways to look at the same underlying list:

- **A list view** — every outstanding filing, soonest due date first, with one-click filters such as overdue, due this week, due this month, needing confirmation, or completed. The summary counts at the top of the screen and the rows underneath are always kept in sync with each other, so they can never show conflicting numbers.
- **A month view** — a familiar calendar grid, one query loads the whole visible month so it feels instant rather than paginated day by day.
- **A detail view** — opens a single filing to show its full history, links to the same filing in other periods or for other registrations of the same client, and any penalty exposure if it runs late.

One deliberate design rule runs through all three views: the same status — overdue, due soon, in progress, complete, and so on — always uses the same word, colour and icon everywhere it appears. A user should never have to learn a second visual language for the same idea on a different screen. Loading more items further down a list is a deliberate click, not an endless scroll, and an empty screen always explains *why* it's empty — whether that's because filters are narrowing things down, because this particular time window has nothing in it, or because a client genuinely has no filings yet — so a user is never left guessing whether “nothing here” is good news or a mistake.



How a filing's due date becomes a tracked, assigned piece of work.

4. Getting the work done: assignment

Assignment works at two levels today:

- **The whole filing** can be handed to one person, either one at a time or many filings at once. Whoever is picked must actually belong to that client's team — this is checked again on the server at the moment of assignment, so it cannot be bypassed by tampering with the request that a browser sends.
- **Individual steps within a filing** — for filings that use a checklist (for example, Prepare, Review, Approve, File), each step can have its own owner, who may or may not be the same person responsible for the filing overall. If nobody has manually assigned a step, the system picks the earliest available team member who holds the matching role — a convenience that has a real limitation, covered in the next section.

As a deadline approaches — and again after it has passed — reminders go out automatically by WhatsApp and email on a fixed schedule (a week before, three days before, the day before, then every few days once overdue), and the same reminder can be triggered manually at any time. The schedule is careful never to send the same reminder twice, even if the underlying process is re-run.

If a filing genuinely does not apply, a person can dismiss or postpone it, and that decision sticks — the next night's automatic update will not bring it back unless someone reverses the decision. Today, for day-to-day manual tracking, the formal “send for review” / “approve” hand-off is intentionally kept out of view: the working assumption is that one person tracks a filing from start to finish. The underlying capability for a fuller review chain already exists in the system; it has simply been switched off for this style of use, not removed.

5. Where the workflow falls short today

These are functional gaps observed in how the system behaves right now, independent of how any one person experiences them day to day (that follows in the next section).

- 1 Preparer and reviewer are not actually kept separate.** Nothing stops the same person from preparing a filing and then also being the one who reviews or approves it. Only “does this person hold the right role” is checked, never “is this a different person from whoever acted before.”
- 2 Auto-assignment does not check client-level access.** When a checklist step is assigned automatically, the system looks for someone with the right general role, but does not confirm that person is actually permitted to work on that specific client. The mismatch only surfaces when that person tries to open the item and is blocked.
- 3 No bulk reassignment below the level of a whole filing.** Moving all of a departing team member's whole filings to someone else is a single action; moving the individual checklist steps they hold is not — each has to be found and moved one at a time.
- 4 No visibility into how long work takes.** The system knows when a filing last changed status and how many days remain before it's due, but nothing aggregates that into “average time spent in review” or “which reviewer has the longest queue.” Every existing dashboard answers “what's outstanding right now,” never “where is work actually getting stuck.”
- 5 Supporting documents are tracked as all-or-nothing.** A filing can require several distinct supporting documents before it's considered ready to close, but today, uploading just one document marks that whole requirement as satisfied — there is no per-document check yet. This is a known, temporary simplification while a proper document store is being built, not an oversight.
- 6 Recurring filings have no view of their own.** “We file this every month” is not a thing a user can see or manage directly — it only exists indirectly, as a side effect of each period's row being regenerated automatically, linked to its siblings.
- 7 A missed reminder can be lost rather than caught up.** The daily reminder summary only looks back a fixed number of days. If it fails to go out for a couple of days running, items that fall outside that window are quietly left out of the next one rather than being backfilled.

6. What this feels like, day to day

Translating the gaps above into what a person actually experiences using the system:

- **“Why can't I open this?”** — because auto-assignment doesn't check client access, a team member can find a task sitting in their own queue, only to discover on opening it that they were never actually given access to that client. To them, it looks like a stuck task with no visible explanation.
- **“Who's actually supposed to check this?”** — a firm may describe a maker/checker control to a client or auditor, but in practice the same person can prepare and sign off their own filing today,

and the formal review step is hidden from the main screen entirely. Anyone relying on that separation as a genuine control is relying on something that isn't currently enforced.

- **“I thought this was ready.”** — if a filing needs three supporting documents before it can close, uploading just one currently makes the checklist look satisfied. Someone trusting that checklist as their source of truth could hand off a filing that's actually missing two of three attachments.
- **“Offboarding someone is a chore.”** — reassigning a leaver's whole filings takes one action; reassigning the individual steps they hold takes many, found and moved one at a time — exactly the kind of task that gets missed when a team is busy.
- **“I can see what's late, but not what's slow.”** — a manager can see today's overdue list at a glance, but has no way to see whether review consistently takes three days or ten, or which reviewer is the actual bottleneck.
- **“Where do I see our recurring filings as one thing?”** — there isn't a single place that represents “our monthly GST return” as an ongoing item; a user has to piece it together from one period's page and its list of related periods.
- **“Does this work on my phone?”** — the calendar is built for a full browser screen, and whether it holds up well on a phone — a realistic way many people check today's deadline — has not been specifically confirmed.

7. Recommendations, in priority order

Ordered by how much risk or day-to-day friction each one currently causes.

Priority	Recommendation	Why it matters
HIGH	Decide, deliberately, whether preparer and reviewer must be different people — then either build that as a hard rule the system enforces, or update internal documentation to describe today's simpler, single-owner model.	This is the highest-risk item: it affects what the firm can honestly claim about its own controls to a client or an auditor.
HIGH	Make sure work that is assigned automatically only goes to someone who actually has access to that specific client, not just anyone holding the right general role.	Removes a confusing, silent failure mode where a task sits in someone's queue but can't actually be opened.
MEDIUM	Add one-click reassignment for individual checklist steps, not just whole filings.	Turns offboarding a team member from a manual hunt into a single, reliable action.
MEDIUM	Add visibility into how long work is taking — not just what's overdue, but where it's slow — alongside the existing workload views.	Lets a manager act on bottlenecks, not only backlogs.
LOWER	Track each required supporting document individually, rather than treating any one upload as satisfying the whole requirement.	Closes a gap between what the checklist shows as “done” and what has actually been collected.
LOWER	Give recurring filings a view of their own, distinct from each individual period.	Makes an ongoing obligation visible as one thing, instead of something pieced together from related pages.
LOWER	Make the daily reminder summary catch up on anything it missed, instead of quietly dropping older items after a failed send.	Protects the reliability of reminders, which is the whole point of the feature.
LOWER	Confirm, with real testing, that the calendar works well on a phone.	Covers a realistic, everyday way people actually check a deadline.

One open question worth deciding first

The single call that shapes several of the items above: is preparer/reviewer separation meant to be a real, enforced control — something worth building properly — or is today's single-owner, self-tracked model the intended direction, in which case the documentation should simply be brought in line with it? Everything else in this list can proceed either way, but this one is worth settling explicitly rather than by default.